DESAI SETHI
SCHOOL OF ENTREPRENEURSHIP

# IDEAS Program Status Update

## Early Stage Venture Creation & Pre-Incubation

**IDEAS** = **I**nnovation, **D**evelopment and **E**ntrepreneurship with **A**lumni **S**upport

August 2026

# The IDEAS Program Team



## Prof Anu Narasimhan

Professor of Practice

**Desai Sethi School of Entrepreneurship**

Marketing & Strategy



## Dr. Shruti Gupte

Sr. Project Manager – Pre-Incubation Programs

**IDEAS Program, WIE**

Finance, Leadership and Change Management



## Aasiya Chougule

Senior Administrative Assistant

**IDEAS Program**

Academic Operations, Communication & Program Support

# Program Intent

**First decade:** 800 ventures | 70 startups | **$700M+** fund-raise

**First decade:** Community with 1,300+ founders | 700 startups | **$8B+** fund-raise



## Core Principles

- Structured program enabled by mentors (inspired by **MIT VMS)**
- Scalable program with network effects (inspired by **Stanford StartX)**
- Peer learning among cohort members and alumni founders



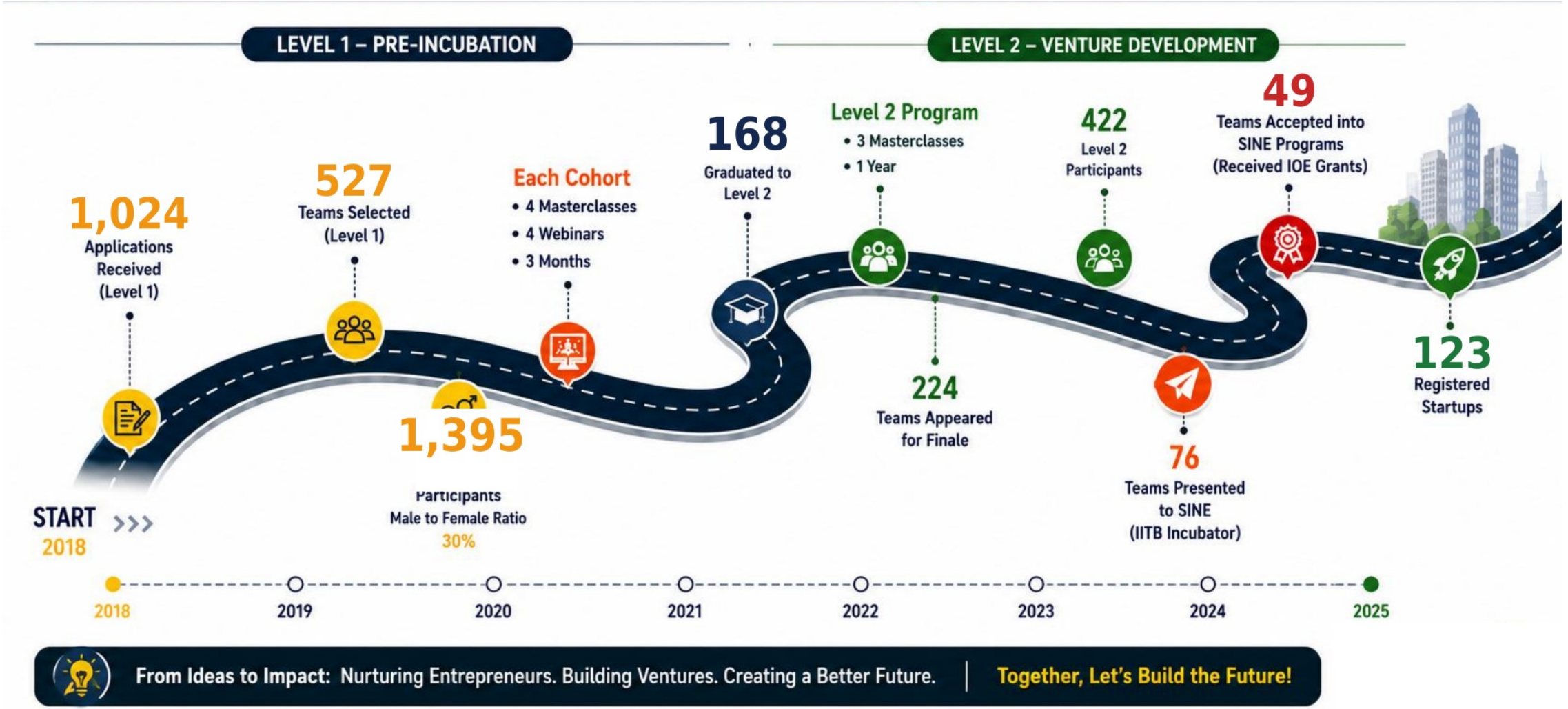
## Mentorship-driven Venture Creation Platform

- Democratize venture creation by enabling anyone with passion to get started
- Encourage teams to adopt outside-in thinking and avoid solutions searching for problems
- Active feedback loops with content and timely inputs to provide directional guidance

**Early Stage Venture Creation & Pre-Incubation**

# IDEAS Venture Development Journey

From 1,024 applications to 123 registered ventures · 2018–2025



# IITB Entrepreneurship Ecosystem



# Structure and Gates

Level 0 → Level 1 → Level 2

★ IDEA Triggers

★ Selection

★ Graduate

★ Demo Day

## Level 0
### Innovation Triggers

- Idea Generation
- Team Building
- Start-up Clinic / Mentor Hours
- ENT Courses

## Level 1
### Problem–Solution Fit

- 3-month structured program
  ₹1 Lakh Grant (~$1,053) | 1 Alumni Mentor
- Weekly coaching on Problem–Solution Fit, Customer Persona & Product Concept
- Evidence-based decision to Go, Pivot or No-Go

## Level 2
### Product–Market Fit

- 12-month structured program
  ₹5 Lakhs Grant (~$5,263) | 2 Alumni Mentors
- Workshops on Technology & NPD, Legal, Finance, Leadership, Sales & Marketing
- Building an MVP and testing for Product–Market Fit

| 527 | 190 | 1,817 | 100+ | 123 | 8 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Level 1 Teams | Level 2 Teams | Aspiring Entrepreneurs | Mentors | Registered Startups | Years |

** 1 USD ≈ ₹95*

# Operationalizing Level 1 Cohort

### 3-Month Cohort-Based Program

Intensive, structured journey for early-stage venture development.

### Focus on Problem–Solution Fit

Helping teams identify, validate and develop solutions for real-world problems.

### Fortnightly Masterclasses & Workshops

On topics related to early-stage ventures, by domain experts.

### Fortnightly Team Webinars

Teams share progress, get mentor input and receive feedback.

### Finale Presentation at End of Cohort

Graduate to Level 2, continue in Level 1, or pivot.

### Team Grant of ₹1 Lakh (~USD 1,053)

Early funding support to accelerate execution.





**3-Month Cohort-Based Pre-Incubation Program**

** 1 USD ≈ ₹95*

# Operationalizing Level 2 Cohorts

### 1-Year Self-Paced Program
Flexible journey over 12 months to build and scale your venture.

### Focus on Product–Market Fit
Validating product–market fit and building sustainable businesses.

### Prototype & MVP with Business Plan
Build MVPs and develop robust business plans with structured guidance.

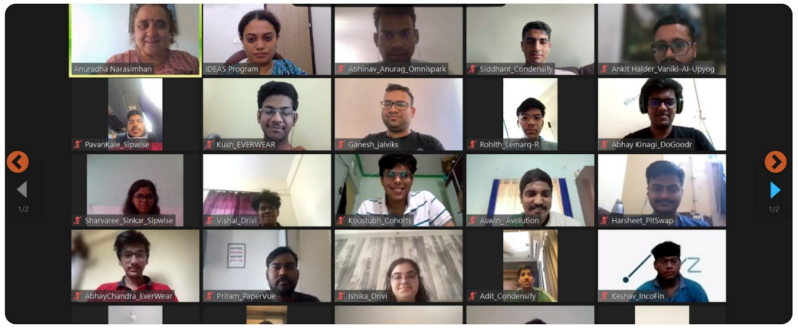
### Masterclasses on IP, Finance & Legal
Expert-led sessions to strengthen key foundational areas.

### Mentor Support on Production / GTM
One-on-one mentoring to help you build, launch and scale.

### Investor Presentations
Pitch to investors and ecosystem partners to accelerate growth.

### Team Grant of ₹5 Lakhs (~USD 5,263)
Seed funding to fuel product development and market entry.





**1-Year Self-Paced Venture Development Program**

| 190 | 422 | 76 | 49 |
|---|---|---|---|
| Teams Selected | Participants | Presented to SINE | Accepted · IOE Grants |

** 1 USD ≈ ₹95*

# Partnerships

## Student Bodies

e-cell
IIT BOMBAY

STAB
Students' Technical Activities Body

INSTITUTION'S INNOVATION COUNCIL
(Ministry of Education Initiative)





## Centres of Excellence

**BETIC**
Biomedical Engineering and Technology Innovation Centre

**FedEx ALFA**
Center for Advanced Logistics and Focused Analytics

**GESH IITB**
Green Energy and Sustainability Research Hub

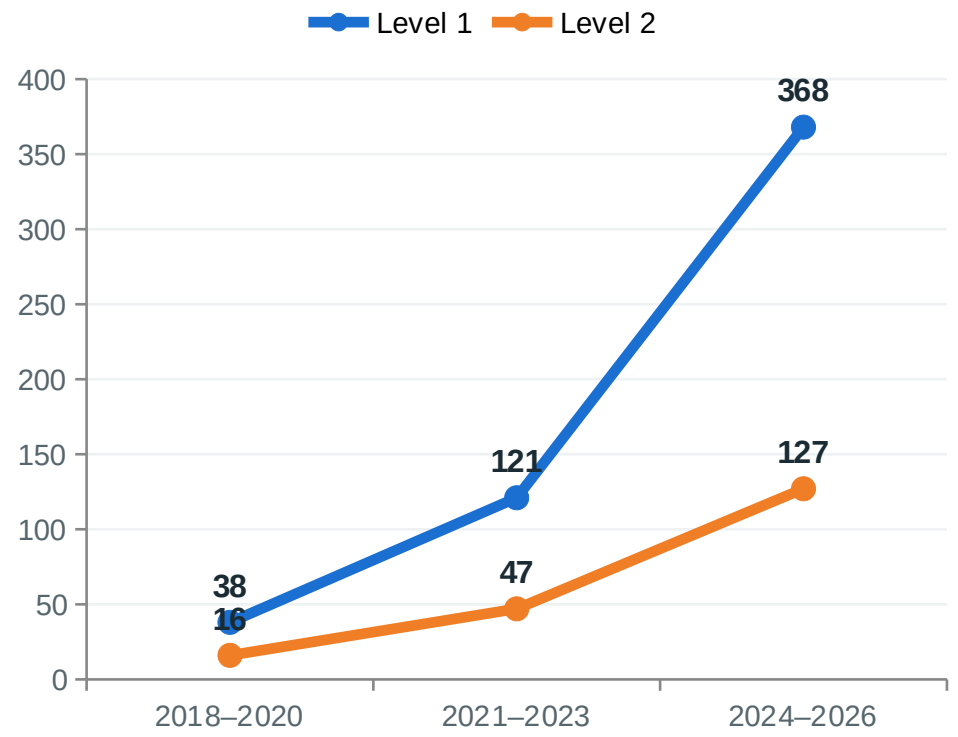
## Incubators / Investors

SINE
*Business Incubator*
IIT Bombay

# Outcomes



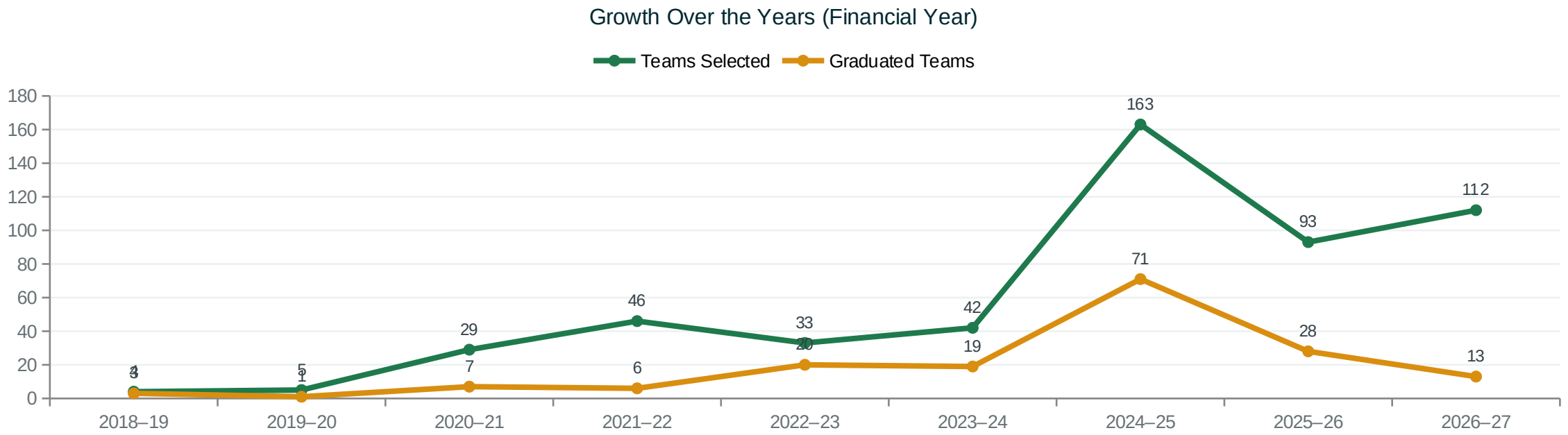

## TEAMS PARTICIPATING (ANNUAL)




**From IDEAS to Impactful Ventures**

# Level 1 Cohorts

| 1,024 | 527 | 1,395 | 168 |
|---|---|---|---|
| Applications Received | Teams Selected | Participants in Cohort | Graduated Teams |




**Applications, Teams and Graduation — 2018 to 2026**

# Level 2 Cohorts

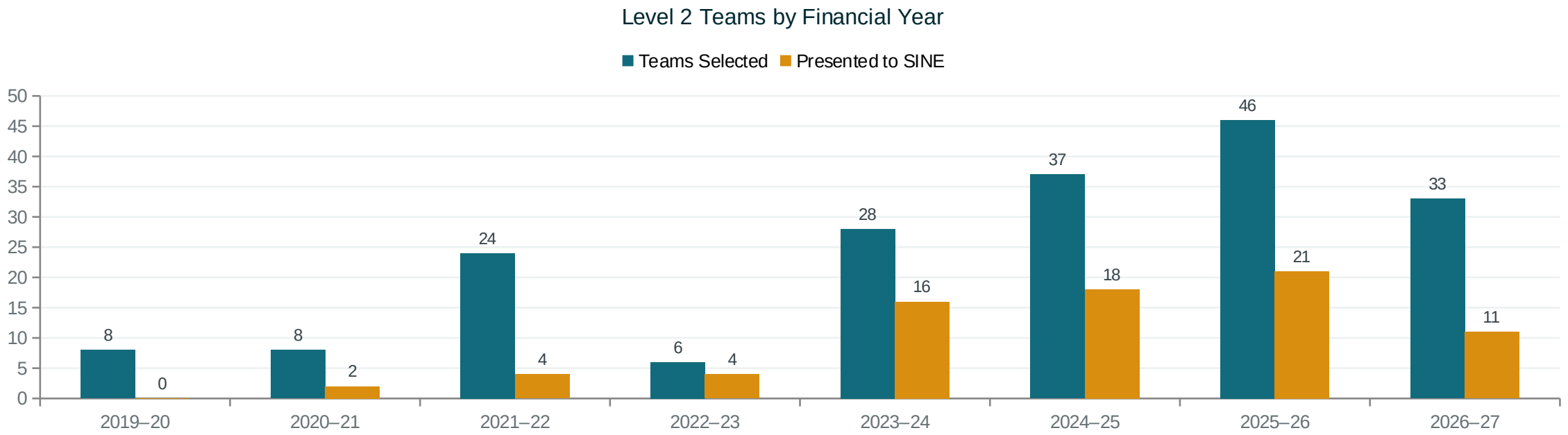
**190**
Teams Selected

**422**
Participants

**249**
Teams Appeared for Finale

**76**
Teams Presented to SINE

**49**
Teams Accepted by SINE




**Nurturing High-Potential Teams. Creating Impact.**

# Startups of DSSE Students

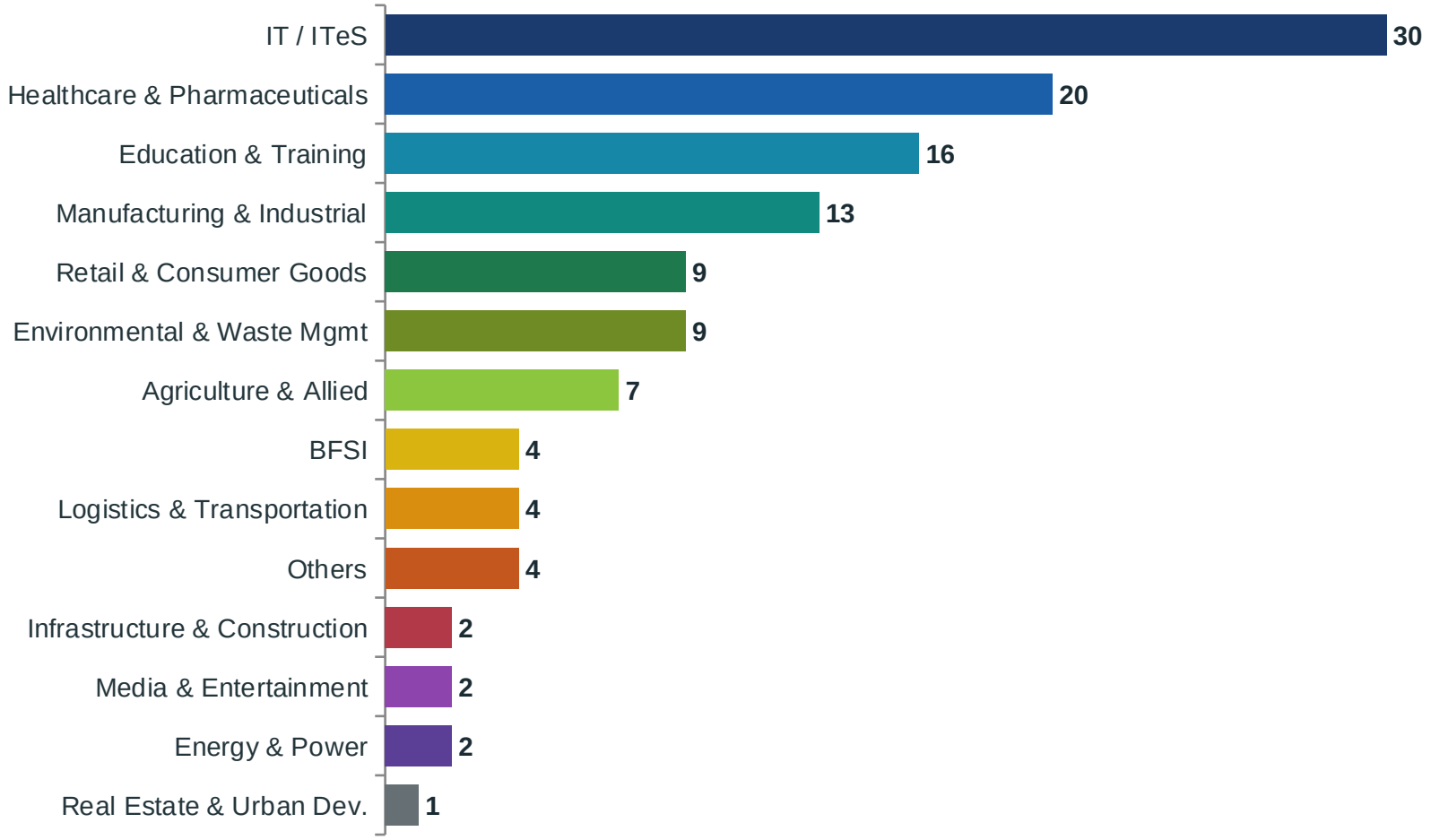
163 Startups by DSSE Students — 123 from the IDEAS Program




*Source: Internet*

# Domains of Venture Teams

123 Registered Ventures across 14 Domains




**123**
Registered Ventures

**14**
Domains

**₹95 Cr+**
Annual Revenue Reported*

**₹32 Cr+**
Disclosed Funds Raised*

**1,000+**
Jobs Created*

**8**
Years of the IDEAS Program

** Aggregated from figures reported by ventures in the Startup Master (13 Jul); many did not disclose — actuals are higher.*

# Funding Journey

Sustained support, growing impact

**Class of 1990 Legacy Funding**

**₹3.00 Cr**

2017 – Present

**IDEAS Program (IOE Support)**

**₹3.23 Cr**

2023 – 2024

**IDEAS Program (FedEx Support)**

**₹1.11 Cr**

2025

**TOTAL IMPACT**

**₹7.34 Cr**

**Sustained Support · From Legacy to Long-Term Impact · Empowering Founders**

**Building the Future of Entrepreneurship**

** 1 USD ≈ ₹95*

# Support Areas for Sponsorship

Where your support goes

## Team Grants

- ₹3,00,000 (~$3,160) sponsorship / Level 1 team — covers grant, research, customer discovery & validation
- ₹6,00,000 (~$6,320) sponsorship / Level 2 team — covers grant, prototype, business planning & GTM

## Honoraria & Expert Support

- Mentor honoraria
- Experts-in-Residence: Legal, Finance, Regulatory, IP, Design, Technology & Go-to-Market

## Prototyping & Product Development

- Hardware & software prototyping · Design, testing & customer validation
- Product refinement & market readiness

## Program Operations

- Program management & coordination · Workshops, events & mentor engagement
- Technology platform & ecosystem support

**Domain-Specific Tracks:** Healthcare · Sustainability · SaaS · AI/ML · FinTech · EdTech · AgriTech · Clean Energy · Mobility · Manufacturing

**Cohort Sponsorship:** sponsor a complete Level 1 / Level 2 cohort or a defined number of teams.

** 1 USD ≈ ₹95*

# Support Required for the IDEAS Program

Annual budget — naming rights available

| Item Head | Cost / Unit | Used For | No. of Units | Annual Budget |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Level 1 Team Grant | ₹3,00,000 (~$3,160) | Research / Travel / Customer Discovery | 80 teams | ₹2.40 Cr (~$252,600) |
| Level 2 Team Grant | ₹6,00,000 (~$6,320) | Prototype Development | 40 teams | ₹2.40 Cr (~$252,600) |
| Mentor Honoraria | ₹1,00,000 (~$1,050) | Providing mentorship to teams | 30 mentors | ₹30 L (~$31,600) |
| Expert Payment | ₹6,00,000 (~$6,320) | IP, Legal, Accounting, GTM, Design | 5 Domain Experts | ₹30 L (~$31,600) |
| Program Management | ₹13,30,000 (~$14,000) | Staffing, Workshops, Tech Platform | Coordinator + PM + Accounts | ₹40 L (~$42,100) |
| **Total** | | | | **₹5.80 Cr (~$610,500)** |

*Donors can sponsor all or parts of the program, including Domain-Specific Tracks or a defined number of Level 1 / Level 2 teams.*

**Your support will empower innovators and build impactful ventures.**

**Let's build the future together!**

** 1 USD ≈ ₹95*

# Startup Showcase: GRUH · Novel Hydrogel · Sustain&Co

## GRUH

Construction Tech | AI | Commerce

### THE PROBLEM

Fragmented material procurement leading to high costs, delays and inefficiencies in the construction industry.




### OUR SOLUTION

Tech-enabled platform that simplifies material sourcing for construction professionals with speed, transparency and reliability.



### INVESTOR HIGHLIGHTS

- ₹15 Lakhs+ Pilot Transactions
- ₹2.75 Lakhs+ Early Revenue
- Marketplace model with high scalability

**GRANT RECEIVED**
₹ 5 Lakhs
(DSSE, IIT Bombay)

**PILOT TRANSACTIONS**
₹ 15 Lakhs+

**REVENUE**
₹ 2.75 Lakhs+

## Novel Hydrogel

HealthTech | Deep Tech

### THE PROBLEM

Diabetic wounds heal slowly and are prone to infections, leading to serious complications and amputations.



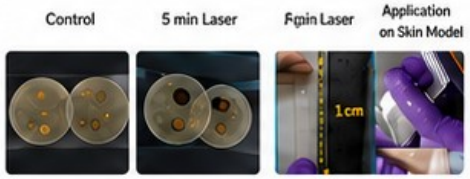

### OUR SOLUTION

Photothermal hydrogel patch that converts NIR light to heat, improving blood flow and accelerating wound healing with antimicrobial action.

### KEY CUSTOMERS

- Diabetologists
- Endocrinologists
- Foot Surgeons

**In-vitro Testing Results**




**TRL LEVEL**
5

**STAGE**
Preclinical

**VALIDATION**
In-vitro Testing

**FUNDING**
₹ 14 Lakhs (Dec 2024)
(SINE to Grant + (DEAS L-2 Grant)

## Sustain&Co

ClimateTech | Energy Analytics

### THE PROBLEM

Lack of reliable data-driven insights for renewable energy planning and decision-making.

**Our Analytics Platform**




### OUR SOLUTION

AI-powered platform offering data-driven tools for renewable energy site assessment, hybrid planning, and predictive analytics.

**CLIMATE INTELLIGENCE DASHBOARD**




### KEY CUSTOMERS

Government agencies, consultants, energy developers, financial institutions and utility companies.

**GRANT RECEIVED**
₹ 9 Lakhs (SINE) + ₹ 3 Lakhs
(DSSE, IIT Bombay)

**TRL LEVEL**
4

**CUSTOMERS**
Government Agencies, Consultants, Energy Developers, Financial Institutions

**PRODUCT**
Interactive Dashboard

*Source: Internet*

Note: ₹ values are approximate and based on an assumed exchange rate of ₹100/USD.

# Startup Showcase: Team Conducting Ink Pen · AquaShodh · SEPAL

## Team Conducting Ink Pen

EdTech | Industrial Learning

**Empowering hands-on STEM learning**

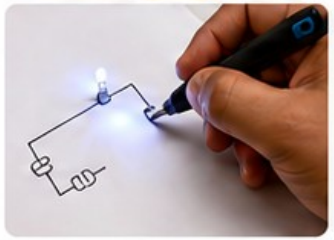
### THE PROBLEM

Traditional STEM learning lacks hands-on experience, making it hard for students to understand basic electricity and circuits.



### OUR SOLUTION

A conducting ink pen that enables students to draw circuits on paper and create real, working connections safely and easily.



### KEY HIGHLIGHTS

- Enables learning electricity without wires
- Hands-on STEM tool for schools
- India's first conducting ink pen

| TRL LEVEL | FUNDING RAISED (SINE-IOE) | STATUS |
|---|---|---|
| 9 | ₹45 Lakhs | Actual system proven through mission operations |
| System Proven | (June 2024) | |

## AquaShodh

NanoInvent Technologies

Deep Tech | Water Purification

**Arsenic removal at nanoscale**

### THE PROBLEM

Presence of heavy metal ions like arsenic in water poses a severe threat to health and environment.




### OUR SOLUTION

Nanoscale technology for efficient removal of arsenic and heavy metals from contaminated water.

### KEY HIGHLIGHTS

- Targets heavy metal contamination (Arsenic)
- Applicable for government labs, industries
- Scalable and cost-effective solution

| TRL LEVEL | STAGE | FUNDING |
|---|---|---|
| 5 | Lab Validated | IOE Grant Supported |
| System Prototype | | |

## SEPAL

Mobility | Auto Accessories

**Smart canopy for rider safety**

### THE PROBLEM

Two-wheeler riders face discomfort and risk due to exposure to sun, rain, dust and cold.



### OUR SOLUTION

A collapsible canopy that attaches to motorcycles, protecting riders from harsh weather conditions.

### KEY HIGHLIGHTS

- Innovative collapsible canopy for two-wheelers
- IoT-enabled for enhanced riding experience
- Designed and developed in India

| RECOGNITION | AWARDS | SUPPORT |
|---|---|---|
| Featured on Shark Tank India | Multiple Innovation Awards | Supported by Government Grants |

*Source: Internet*

Note: ₹ values are approximate and based on an assumed exchange rate of ₹100/USD.

# Startup Showcase: Indrones · Airth · Amaterasu

## Indrones Solutions Pvt Ltd

Domain: DroneTech | Data Analytics

**AI-powered drone analytics platform**

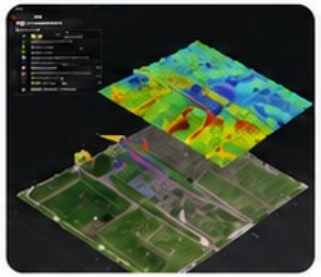
### THE PROBLEM

Traditional data collection methods are time-consuming, expensive and lack accuracy.



### OUR SOLUTION

- UAV-based data acquisition for enterprises & government
- Custom drone solutions for multiple industries
- High-precision, cost-effective aerial insights



### ACHIEVEMENTS & GROWTH

- Government and enterprise deployments
- AI-enabled aerial intelligence solutions
- Scalable drone analytics platform
- Expanding applications across sectors

**FUNDING**
Grant Supported

**STAGE**
Commercial Pilots

## Airth

Domain: CleanTech | Air Quality

**World's First AC-Based Air Purification System**

### THE PROBLEM

Indoor air pollution caused by dust, allergens, bacteria and harmful gases affects health and productivity.




### OUR SOLUTION

- Removes 99% of pollutants, allergens, bacteria & harmful gases
- Works seamlessly with existing AC systems
- Enhances indoor air quality efficiently with low maintenance



### INVESTOR HIGHLIGHTS

- Strong product-market relevance
- Scalable B2C + B2B use cases
- Aligned with sustainability goals

**TRL LEVEL**
7
(System Prototype)

**STAGE**
Market Deployment

**FUNDING**
Venture Backed

## Amaterasu

Domain: HealthTech | Light Therapy

**Artificial Sunlight for Indoor Well-Being**

### THE PROBLEM

Lack of natural sunlight indoors leads to deficiency of Vitamin D, mood disorders, and reduced productivity.



### OUR SOLUTION

- Multi-wavelength lighting system replicating natural sunlight
- Supports mood, focus, Vitamin D & overall well-being
- Safe, energy-efficient and easy to use

- Focus & Mood (Blue)
- Beauty (Red & NIR)
- Vitamin D (UVB)
- Comfort (Far-IR)

### MARKET POTENTIAL

- Wellness & Healthcare Applications
- Corporate & Home Segments
- Scalable Global Market Opportunity

**RECOGNITION**
Featured on Shark Tank India

**AWARDS**
Multiple Innovation Awards

**SUPPORT**
Supported by Government Grants

*Source: Internet*

**Note:** ₹ values are approximate and based on an assumed exchange rate of ₹100/USD.

# Startup Showcase: ScrubStudio · GRADPIPE · MedNest AI

## ScrubStudio

Personalized Skincare Tech

### Personalized Skincare, Made for You

**THE PROBLEM**

Generic skincare products don't address individual skin needs, leading to inefficacy and waste.




**OUR SOLUTION**

- Modular skincare podette with refillable pods
- Dual-use scrub-mask formulations
- Personalized, sustainable and science-backed skincare



**KEY HIGHLIGHTS**

- Personalized skincare solution
- Sustainable & refillable system
- Science-Backed & Dermatologist Approved
- Designed for daily & diverse skin needs

**FUNDING** Grant Supported

**STAGE** Product Development

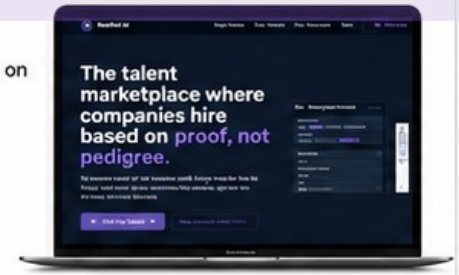
## GRADPIPE

Hiring Tech

### The Talent Marketplace for Proof, Not Pedigree

**THE PROBLEM**

Traditional hiring focuses on resumes and degrees, missing real skills and project experience.




**OUR SOLUTION**

- AI-powered career co-pilot for students
- Personalized career guidance & project matchmaking
- Proof-based talent marketplace for companies
- Discover & engage top 1% of student talent
- Verified projects & skill analytics

**KEY HIGHLIGHTS**

- 1,000+ User Community
- $1,000+ Revenue Generated Within 3 Weeks of MVP Launch
- MVP Product Status
- Verified Projects & Skill Analytics

**TRL LEVEL** 7 (System Prototype)

**STAGE** Market Deployment

**FUNDING** Venture Backed

## MedNest AI

HealthTech | AI Diagnostics

### Automating Radiology Reporting

**THE PROBLEM**

Radiologists spend significant time on routine reporting, leading to delays and high workload.



**OUR SOLUTION**

- AI-powered radiology report dictation
- Converts speech to accurate structured reports
- Saves time and improves reporting accuracy

- Voice to Report
- Structured & Accurate
- Fast & Efficient
- Secure & Compliant

**CUSTOMER SEGMENTS**

- Tele-radiologists
- Large Hospitals
- Independent Practices
- Diagnostic Centers

**TRACTION & IMPACT**

- 10+ Active Users
- $10,000 Raised (Dec '24)
- SINE IoE Grant + IDEAS Level 2 Grant

**RECOGNITION** Featured on Shark Tank India

**AWARDS** Multiple Innovation Awards

**SUPPORT** Supported by Government Grants

Source: Internet

Note: ₹ values are approximate and based on an assumed exchange rate of ₹100/USD.

# Startup Showcase: SIPWISE · JALVIKS · PAAVAN

## SIPWISE

Hydration. Intelligent. Yours.

**Domain:** HealthTech | Hydration & Wellness

### Smart Hydration for a Healthier You




**THE PROBLEM**

People don't drink enough water daily, leading to poor health, low energy and productivity.

**OUR SOLUTION**

SIPWISE is a smart hydration bottle with UV-C sterilization, hydration tracking, reminders and insights to build healthy hydration habits.

**KEY HIGHLIGHTS**

- UV-C Self-Cleaning Technology for 99.9% germ protection
- Tracks intake & reminds you to stay hydrated
- Insights & goals through companion app
- Designed for individuals and corporate wellness

| CUSTOMERS | USE CASES | STATUS | BUSINESS MODEL |
|---|---|---|---|
| Individuals & Corporate Wellness Programs | Daily Health, Fitness, Offices, Travel | Product Live & Market Available | D2C Sales, Corporate Partnerships |

## JALVIKS

**Domain:** AgriTech | Climate Intelligence

### Climate Intelligence for Resilient Agriculture

**THE PROBLEM**

Farmers face climate uncertainty, inefficient irrigation and low yields due to lack of real-time, actionable insights.




**OUR SOLUTION**

Jalviks combines satellite data, on-field sensors and AI to deliver precision irrigation, crop health monitoring and climate risk advisory at the field level.

**KEY HIGHLIGHTS**

- High-resolution Satellite, IoT & AI Platform
- Actionable Insights for Irrigation & Crop Management
- Improves Yields, Saves Water & Reduces Risks
- Serving FPOs, Agri Enterprises and Government Programs

| CUSTOMERS | IMPACT | STATUS | BUSINESS MODEL |
|---|---|---|---|
| FPOs, Farmers, Agri Enterprises, Govt. Programs | Water Savings, Higher Yields, Climate Resilience | Pilots & Paid Deployments Ongoing | SaaS Platform, Subscriptions, Data Services |

## PAAVAN

GO ELECTRIC

**Domain:** Clean Mobility | E-Cycles

### Affordable E -Cycles for a Sustainable Tomorrow

**THE PROBLEM**

Students and last-mile delivery partners need affordable, efficient and eco-friendly mobility options.



**OUR SOLUTION**

Paavan Go Electric builds smart, durable and affordable electric cycles for students and delivery professionals.

- Up to 50 km Range per Charge
- Cost-effective & Low Maintenance
- Ideal for Campuses & Daily Commute
- Promoting Sustainable Mobility

**KEY HIGHLIGHTS**

- Up to 50 km Range per Charge
- Cost-effective, Low Maintenance & Made for India
- Ideal for Campuses, Daily Commute and Deliveries
- Promoting Sustainable & Healthy Mobility

| CUSTOMERS | RANGE | STATUS | BUSINESS MODEL |
|---|---|---|---|
| Students, Delivery Partners, Fleet Operators | Up to 50 km per Charge | Product Development & Pilots | Product Sales, B2B Fleet Partnerships |

**OUR MISSION:** Building innovative, scalable and sustainable solutions that create real impact. | **OUR VISION:** Empowering lives and shaping a better, greener future.

*Source: Internet*

Note: ₹ values are approximate and based on an assumed exchange rate of ₹100/USD.

# IDEAS Masterclass & Webinar



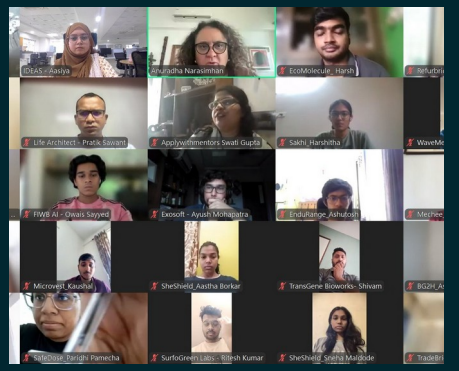












# DSSE Building

The home of the IDEAS Program — IIT Bombay







**Desai Sethi School of Entrepreneurship · IIT Bombay, Powai**

# THANK YOU!

**We appreciate your time and support.**

For collaborations, partnerships and startup engagement, feel free to connect with us.


**IDEAS Program**
Desai Sethi School of Entrepreneurship
IIT Bombay

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